



What actually went right last week

The 5 stories readers chose, week of 28 September

Zoom out: in 1990 the ozone hole was growing every year. It is now the smallest since records began.

70 acres

A farmer turned 70 acres of his Oregon barley farm into a wetland, and 200 bird species came back.

What it proves: Farmland can be given back to nature by one person deciding to do it.

194

Britain's smallest wild pig is back: a breeding programme has taken the pygmy hog from six known animals to 194.

What it proves: A species written off in the 1990s can be rebuilt when someone keeps at it for thirty years.

97 percent

A single injection cut inherited high cholesterol by 97 percent for 48 weeks in an early trial.

What it proves: A condition that needed daily pills for life may become a once-a-year appointment.

first

Norway launched its first orbital rocket from Andoya, the first from mainland Europe.

What it proves: Space access no longer belongs only to the countries that started early.

A six-year-old in Cologne recognised her family's stolen car in traffic and led police to it.

What it proves: Paying attention is a skill that does not wait for adulthood.

The stories, in full

1. www.thebetterindia.com/oregon-wetland-2026
2. news.mongabay.com/pygmy-hog-assam-2026
3. www.bbc.com/news/health-cholesterol-2026
4. www.euronews.com/isar-andoya-2026
5. www.20min.ch/koeln-auto-2026

“The best way to find out if you can trust somebody is to trust them.”

Ernest Hemingway

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